

Share and Celebrate StoryDogs

Choose one simple ending for a class, library group, or pair.

An outline is worth sharing. Children do not need a polished draft to celebrate a character, a surprising problem, or a brave choice. Tell them they can share with a partner or ask you to read for them.

Read the seven parts aloud

Allow 3–5 minutes. Read a class story yourself, or invite volunteers to read one stage each. For individual stories, partners take turns; each listener names a moment they pictured clearly. Invite two volunteers to share with the room if time allows.

Say: “Listen for what the character wants, what gets harder, and what they do at the biggest moment.”

Perform a favorite moment

Allow 5–8 minutes. Choose one scene and a narrator. Volunteers can play characters, hold a drawing, or make a sound effect. Narrate the setup, freeze at the problem, and ask the character what they choose to do. Act the result and finish with one line showing what changed.

Keep movement in a clear space. Participation can be from a seat, and performing is always optional.

Draw the moment worth remembering

Allow 5–10 minutes. Ask children to draw the funniest, hardest, or most important moment. Add a caption or take dictation. In pairs, one child points to a detail while the other asks a question. A quick gallery walk is optional.

Give feedback a child can use

Start with something specific: “I could picture ____” or “I wanted to find out ____.” Then ask one curious question: “What made your character choose that?” Let the storyteller decide what to revise. Save spelling corrections for a later pass.

Notice a change before you finish

Ask: “At the start, your character _____. At the end, they _____.” If children name a lesson, ask what action shows it. Older students can discuss how a failed attempt led to the climax; younger children can draw a before-and-after pair.

Leave with a next step

Say: “You made a story today. Next time, choose one moment to turn into a picture, comic, or scene.” Save the class outline or let children take their planning sheets home. Display or share student work using your usual school or library permissions.